

8.1.2 Chat Clients

Like Linux users, Mac users have to make some sacrifices when it comes to chat clients—while good clients exist, they aren't as full-featured as their Windows counterparts.

Adium

This is a free, open source, instant messaging client based on the lib-gaim library. Simply put, Adium is one of the best IM clients across all platforms, if not the best. It supports multiple protocols like AIM, ICQ, Yahoo, MSN, iChat, Google Talk, and more. The current version is 1.0.1, which was released as recently as February 2007.

Adium boasts of a large number of features including a plugin manager, fully customisable user interface, tabbed chat windows, file transfer with multiple protocols, chat logging, and more. It has a near-dominance in the Mac world.

Yahoo! Messenger

Yes, Yahoo does release software for platforms other than Windows! After years and years of no development, Yahoo! sprung a bit of a surprise with their beta version of Yahoo! Messenger 3 late last year. The latest version is 3.0b1. Yahoo! Messenger for OS X boasts of a native Mac Cocoa interface, along with an extremely well-designed user interface. Its features are the same as those of Yahoo! Messenger for Windows. However, it does not support voice chat or audibles, which are quite popular among Windows users.

However, Yahoo! has promised to include voice chat support in beta 2 of Yahoo! Mes-



Adium running the Google Talk, Yahoo and MSN protocols